

Leif Taylor

AI-NATIVE PRINCIPAL ENGINEER • CUSTOMER-EMBEDDED

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I embed with enterprise customer teams to take generative AI from prototype to production — full-stack, full-lifecycle, then extract the patterns so the next engagement goes 2× faster.

HOW I WORK

I work end-to-end. One operator across product translation, architecture, full-stack code, tests, infrastructure, and production — agentic workflows for speed, deep architectural judgment for trust.

Where a 2019 team spent a quarter coordinating handoffs across specialists, I ship a working system in weeks.

Same correctness bar. Same operability bar. Aimed at the business outcome the brief actually asked for.

OUTCOMES

AI matching	Built AI-assisted supplier-matching and R&D workflow primitives for Chemveric — semantic retrieval and capability scoring across chemistry expertise, scale, geography, timelines, and regulatory constraints, with structured RFQ intelligence on top.
AI moderation	Architected the trust-and-safety layer for Imprint.live, an AI-driven social platform — OpenAI-powered content classification, moderation queues, policy enforcement, human-review boundaries, and audit trails across user-generated content workflows.
0 → 1	Direct-to-Supplier Ordering at ConnectBase. Greenfield concept to production in months — wholesalers and channel partners now purchase from thousands of suppliers in one interface, with AI-assisted supplier ingestion underneath.
Image GenAI	Four years of self-funded image-generation R&D — production pipelines integrating inpainting, outpainting, AI upscaling, and textual-inversion-based subject consistency. Shipped into creative-asset workflows.
Email → RFQ	Converted fragmented pharma procurement (emails, spreadsheets, vendor portals) into a structured RFQ workflow at Chemveric — buyer/supplier portals, RFQ lifecycle state, quote normalization, side-by-side comparison, and procurement audit trail.
1M+ products	Architected the data and search layer for Chemveric's B2B chemical marketplace — multi-source ingestion, CAS-aware catalog normalization, faceted discovery, and structured search across millions of products and thousands of supplier records.
Distributed CPQ	Re-architected ConnectBase's telecom CPQ engine from a coordination-heavy monolith into a distributed, worker-driven quoting platform — concurrent quote computation, fault isolation, horizontal scale, and bulk pricing across complex multi-location connectivity scenarios.
\$600K · 2 mo	Azure spend reduction at ConnectBase. Same product, same headcount — architectural and operational discipline did the work, and the savings landed inside the first quarter.
Multi-module IaC	Built the Terraform / Kubernetes deployment substrate for Mobile Heartbeat's modular cloud-native healthcare communication platform — repeatable provisioning, secrets, ingress, observability, and CI/CD across independently deployable clinical modules.

EXPERIENCE

ConnectBase

Mar 2023 – Present

PRINCIPAL ENGINEER **CURRENT** 2025 – Present

- Reengineered the monolithic pricing engine into a distributed worker-driven architecture (concurrent quote computation, fault isolation, horizontal scale)
- Modernized legacy VM-era patterns into stateless, horizontally-scalable services
- Chief developer and technical owner of the Direct-to-Supplier Ordering platform — wholesalers and channel partners purchase from thousands of suppliers in one interface
- Integrated AI-assisted workflows for supplier ingestion, semantic search, TAM analysis, and data-layer intelligence
- Daily use of agentic dev workflows (Claude Code, sub-agent orchestration, MCP-style tool integration) across implementation, refactoring, and architecture iteration
- Built and maintains the team operating patterns for AI-augmented delivery — when to delegate to an agent, where the human-in-the-loop boundary sits, how to validate generated work

↑ Promoted to Principal Engineer (2025)

DIRECTOR OF DEVOPS 2023 – 2025

- Reduced Azure spend by \$50K+/month → \$600K+ annualized savings, in 2 months
- Modernized 30+ legacy VM-hosted services into stateless, horizontally-scalable microservices
- Built CI/CD across 30+ heterogeneous services (Java, TypeScript / Node, Python, C#)
- Stood up enterprise-wide feature-flag, secrets-management, and progressive (canary) delivery infrastructure
- Stood up unit / functional / e2e coverage across the suite using AI-assisted test authorship
- Disaster-recovery and outage point person

Mobile Heartbeat

Jan 2019 – Mar 2023

PRINCIPAL DEVOPS LEAD Promoted from Senior DevOps Engineer

- Designed a serverless internal application testing framework, fully Terraform-driven, integrated into CI/CD
- Built CI/CD for multitenant microservice apps on Azure — Terraform + Flux/Helm + Kubernetes + automated test deployment + DB bootstrapping
- Designed CI/CD pipelines for iOS and Android mobile applications
- Customer-release support across Android, iOS, and Windows platforms

Actifio

Jun 2016 – Jan 2019

HEAD OF DEVOPS Promoted from DevOps Intern → Lead → Head

- Chief developer of the automated regression testing framework — Python/Node + Docker + Ansible + Jenkins + Robot Framework
- Managed 100+ dev databases (Oracle, SQL Server) and 2,000+ VMs across on-prem ESXi, Hyper-V, physical hosts, and AWS EC2
- Travelled to India to mentor and code-review the distributed engineering team
- Built developer-portal tooling: test execution, host management, log analysis

CONSULTING & FRACTIONAL

Chemveric — Technical Director

2025 – 2026

Architected and led end-to-end development of a B2B SaaS cheminformatics marketplace connecting buyers and suppliers of research chemicals and materials. Multi-tenant NestJS / Postgres / RDKit / AWS, with AI-assisted ingestion, RFQ workflows, and funding-opportunity matching.

Alacrity Solutions — Founding Member · Principal Architect

2022 — Present

AI consulting practice helping F500s operationalize LLMs for software development, customer support, finance, compliance, and scientific data. Delivered work for global tax-tech, computational-science, and industrial-chemistry clients.

Imprint.live — CTO · Principal Architect

2022 — 2023

Led development of an AI-driven social platform — OpenAI-powered moderation, synthetic-user systems, user-value analytics for stakeholders.

Open Interpreter — Contributor

2023 — 2024

The desktop app for AI power users — let agents edit files, control apps, and learn new skills. Contributor to local-LLM execution patterns. 64k+ stars on GitHub. github.com/openinterpreter/open-interpreter

TOOLKIT

AI / LLM SYSTEMS

OpenAI · Anthropic · Azure OpenAI · Amazon Bedrock · Vertex AI · Claude Code · Cursor · MCP · LangChain · LangGraph · LlamaIndex · tool-calling agents · structured outputs · function calling · RAG · multi-agent systems · agent orchestration · eval harnesses · prompt-version control · AI observability · HITL workflows · local LLMs · Ollama · context engineering

GENERATIVE AI / IMAGE

Stable Diffusion · SDXL · ComfyUI · Diffusers · ControlNet · LoRA · textual inversion · IP-Adapter · inpainting · outpainting · image upscaling · background removal

RETRIEVAL / DATA INTELLIGENCE

Pinecone · Weaviate · Qdrant · Milvus · Chroma · FAISS · pgvector · Elasticsearch / OpenSearch vector search · hybrid retrieval · BM25 · embeddings · reranking · cross-encoder rerankers · metadata filtering · chunking strategies · document ingestion · OCR / unstructured extraction · entity resolution · deduplication · knowledge graphs · LangSmith · Langfuse · RAGAS

APPLICATION ENGINEERING

TypeScript · Node.js · NestJS · Express · Fastify · Next.js · Python · FastAPI · Pydantic · Django · Java · Spring Boot · C# · .NET · ASP.NET Core · React · React Native · Angular · Svelte / SvelteKit · Vite · Tailwind CSS · Storybook · TanStack Query · REST · GraphQL · gRPC · WebSockets · OpenAPI · webhooks · OAuth2 · OIDC · JWT · SAML · SCIM · API gateways · idempotency · rate limiting

CLOUD / PLATFORM / DEVOPS

Azure · AWS · GCP · Cloudflare · Kubernetes · AKS · EKS · ECS · AWS Lambda · Azure Functions · Cloudflare Workers / Pages · Docker · Terraform · Pulumi · Helm · Flux · Argo CD · Ansible · Vault · GitHub Actions · Azure DevOps · GitLab CI · Jenkins · CircleCI · serverless · service mesh · platform engineering · internal developer platforms · golden paths · Backstage · feature flags · progressive delivery · canary deploys · blue/green · FinOps

DATA / DISTRIBUTED SYSTEMS

PostgreSQL · MySQL · SQL Server · Oracle · CockroachDB · Aurora · MongoDB · DynamoDB · Redis · Snowflake · BigQuery · Databricks · TimescaleDB · Elasticsearch · Kafka · RabbitMQ · SQS / SNS · EventBridge · Temporal · worker queues · sagas · outbox pattern · CQRS · event sourcing · CDC · dbt · Airflow · Spark · sharding · replication

RELIABILITY / SECURITY / QUALITY

OpenTelemetry · Datadog · Prometheus · Grafana · distributed tracing · structured logging · SLOs / SLIs · error budgets · incident command · postmortems · runbooks · on-call · DR · load testing · k6 · OWASP Top 10 · IAM · RBAC / ABAC · zero trust · secrets management · audit logging · PII handling · supply-chain security · Jest · Vitest · Pytest · Playwright · AI-assisted test authorship · LLM regression evals · golden datasets

FORWARD-DEPLOYED / CUSTOMER ENGINEERING

technical discovery workshops · customer co-development · executive technical communication · prototype-to-production delivery · reusable implementation patterns · playbooks · product feedback synthesis · rapid prototyping